

Cars

The first cars were invented more than 130 years ago. Originally known as “horseless carriages”, these early models were slow, open-topped vehicles, but today’s cars are fast, stylish, and can be powered by petrol, diesel, or electricity.

HOW A CAR WORKS

The power that turns a car’s wheels comes from the car’s internal combustion engine. Combustion is a kind of burning that takes place inside the engine when air is mixed with petrol or diesel, compressed, and ignited with a spark.

1. INSIDE THE ENGINE

Air and petrol (or diesel) are sucked into cylinders inside the engine by pistons, which then compress the mixture. A spark plug ignites it, providing energy.

2. IN GEAR

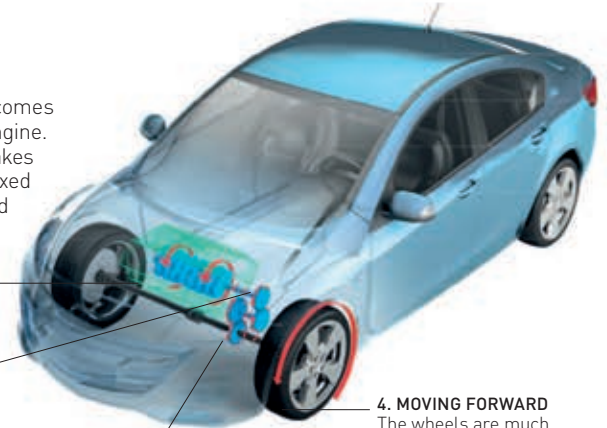
The pistons move very fast, but a car needs more force and less speed to start moving. Gears control the force and speed the car receives.

3. TURNING WHEELS

The gears turn rods called axles. Wheels are attached to these axles, so they turn too.

4. MOVING FORWARD

The wheels are much bigger than the axles, so as they turn they cover a lot of ground quickly, moving the car forward.



BESTSELLING CARS

In 1901 only 600 cars were sold around the world. By 2014 yearly car sales had reached 71 million. Some models have sold in huge numbers, as shown below.

1 TOYOTA COROLLA

The world’s bestselling car, over 40 million of this Japanese model have been sold since 1966.

2 FORD F-SERIES

Ford have sold more than 35 million of these chunky pick-up trucks since they were introduced in 1948.



FORD F-SERIES
1948

3 VOLKSWAGEN GOLF

Introduced in 1974, the Golf has been consistently popular – 27.5 million have been sold.

4 VOLKSWAGEN BEETLE

First produced in 1933, 23.5 million Beetles have been sold worldwide.



VOLKSWAGEN
BEETLE 1948

5 FORD ESCORT

These family cars were produced from 1968. Sales eventually topped 20 million.

6 HONDA CIVIC

Honda was about to stop making cars before creating the Civic in 1972. 18.5 million have sold.

7 HONDA ACCORD

The first Japanese car produced in the USA, Honda has sold 17.5 million Accords since 1976.

8 FORD MODEL T

The original affordable car, Ford sold 16.5 million of these between 1908 and 1927.

9 VOLKSWAGEN PASSAT

Seven generations of Passat have seen total sales of above 15.5 million since 1973.

10 CHEVROLET IMPALA

Chevrolet have sold 14 million of these since the car was introduced in 1958.

CHEVROLET
IMPALA 1960



**THE FERRARI LAFERRARI
CAN REACH 100 KM/H
(62 MPH) IN UNDER
THREE SECONDS**



FERRARI
LAFERRARI
2013



MASERATI
GRANTURISMO
MC STRADALE
2011

SUPERCARS

Cars that are designed to be faster, sleeker, and more powerful than normal cars are called supercars. They use cutting-edge materials and technology, and are very expensive. They are the cars that make onlookers say “Wow!”.



Benz
Motorwagen

1886

Benz Motorwagen is the first petrol-fuelled automobile.

1901

Lohner-Porsche produces the first hybrid cars, which can run on an electric battery and petrol.

1908

The Ford Model T is the first affordable car.

1913

Ford operates first moving car assembly line.

1928

Bentley wins Le Mans race.



Bentley
4 1/2 Litre

1954

Mercedes-Benz 300 SL “Gull Wing” is first production car to exceed 241 km/h (150 mph).

1886

CARS THROUGH TIME

The first petrol-fuelled cars reached a top speed of 19 km/h (12 mph). Since then, technology has given us affordable, faster, and safer cars with speeds of up to 435 km/h (270 mph).

1893

Duryea Motor Wagon is the first successful car powered by petrol.

1903

Mercedes Simplex 60HP can reach 120 km/h (75 mph).



Mercedes Simplex 60HP

1910

First four-wheel brake system is patented by Argyll Motors, Scotland.



Argyll Landaulette

1934

Citroën Traction Avant is first successful front-wheel-drive made for the mass-market.



Citroën Traction Avant

1948

Jaguar XK120 reaches 200 km/h (124.6 mph).